

Openmoko Neo FreeRunner Freedom Beckons?

Advertising itself as a *free phone* is misleading, for you will not be getting the *Neo FreeRunner* as a gift any time soon. The novel concept turns out to be a phone based on a Linux based OS called *Openmoko GNU*. The device itself is physically rugged and the hard rubberised finish exudes quality. With a Nokia N-Gage like shape, the FreeRunner has a very large eyehole built into the bottom and looks like a GPS unit. The screen is ultra crisp—even the bootup screen, which has really microscopic text, is very readable. At 2.8-inches, it's at par with most PDA screens, the resolution is a crisp 480 x 640 pixels—which is much better than average. Processing grunt is provided by a single core ARM9 processor clocked at 400 MHz, we'd like a faster CPU as the interface lags a bit.

There's a command line interface provided which speeds things up—but only Linux users will be able to utilise this feature. A camera has been forgotten. As with any open source application or Linux distro the real potential of this phone lies on the Web, once you get down to trying out all the free applications—which really unleash the potential of open source applications. Since the source code is available Linux aficionados will dig into the FreeRunners software innards. Openmoko also provides you the liberty to actually access the Neo FreeRunners PCB, although how useful this feature is to regular users we leave to the individual. While the Web site has a section dedicated to opening your FreeRunner we didn't see many options to mod the device.



Our device was very shy on application support—no document editor or PDF reader or any PMP capabilities, but we're told that all these applications will be added soon. Sadly no applications were available for download at the time of reviewing this product. We found the on-screen number pad to be too small, perhaps future software revisions will remedy this. In terms of signal quality we had hardly any issues, and handsfree quality was good although due to its elongated ends the Neo Runner does feel bulky in hand, and weighs a ton in cellphone terms—185 grams. As a phone, this is a device that's flawed in terms of usability and users looking for a func-

tional platform will definitely look elsewhere. At Rs 22,000 the FreeRunner is costly, but not for Linux buffs.

Specifications
CPU—400 MHz ARM9, RAM—128 MB, ROM—256 MB, MicroSD expansion, GPS, WiFi, Linux/GNU based, 185 grams

Contact
Phone: 011-413243321
E-mail: sales@idasystems.net
Web site: www.idasystems.net
Price: Rs 22,000

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★☆
Performance	★★★★☆
Build Quality	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆

Cooler Master Elite 330 A Case Of Mediocrity

The large numbers of cheap cabinets are slowly being sidetracked with brands known world over bringing their offerings to the India market. The Elite 330 from Cooler Master arrives to bring in some sanity by trying to get entry level cabinets some quality and decent design. This new case has a decent design and doesn't have an out-of-the-world look that will amaze anyone. The quality isn't all that impressive either. The panels are made of really thin metal and they wobble and flex a lot. The top being a comparatively smaller area feels sturdier.

The interiors have smoothly folded metal edges so users don't get scratches and bruises while working on the insides of the cabinet. There are thumbscrews on one side of the cabinet. There are a few useful locking mechanisms to hold the rear expansion panels in place and lock all the drives in their bays.



For cooling, there is a single 120 mm fan at the rear of the cabinet and there is space for additional fans in the front. The side panel has a vent to funnel air to where the processor usually lies. Cooler Master has dust filters placed where the drives go in. The front of the cabinet has the power and reset buttons, two USB ports and an audio out and microphone in. It also comes with connectors for HD Audio. The power supply that comes with the cabinet is a Cooler Master RS-390-PMSR-A3—a 390 W one from the eXtreme Power series—OK for most onboard graphics solution running systems. The cables are long and the PSU case itself is sturdy. Only the 12V power cable going to the

motherboard comes with sheathing. Although we wouldn't highly recommend this product, if you really want a Cooler Master cabinet at a low price, this Rs 1,950 cabinet is a decent buy.

Specifications
120 mm fan, Motherboards: ATX and Micro-ATX, four 5.25-inch and six 3.25-inch drive bays. 189 x 425 x 485 mm. 6 Kg

Contact
Phone: 9833870302
E-mail: Tanmay_L@Coolermaster.com
Web site: www.coolermaster.com
Price: Rs 1,950

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★☆
Performance	★★★★☆
Build Quality	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆

CoolerMaster Real Power M700 For Mid-range Enthusiasts/Gamers

In the age of 3-way SLI and overclocked quad-core processors, it's easy to get carried away with buying a super high-end power supply even when your PC doesn't really need something that hefty to power it. Enter the CM Real Power M700—a 700W, modular power supply. This unit is built around ATX 12V version 2.3 specifications. The build quality of the unit itself is a mixed bag—cable and connector quality is top notch, but the gauge of sheet used on the body is light. A single 120mm fan provides the basis of cooling. This power supply supports two PCIe power slots, and two each of the six and eight pin connects have been

provided, which means SLI and CrossFire are supported, even for the latest generation of cards like the ATI Radeon HD4870 and NVIDIA GeForce GTX 280. We loaded up an Intel Core 2 Quad Extreme QX9650, 4 GB of RAM, with two WD Raptor 10,000 rpm drives, and a GeForce GTX 280 graphics card. There were no issues with reboots, false starts, or freeze-ups even while stressing the CPU and GPUs with synthetic and real-world benchmarks. For those looking for something basic to power a home PC, this is too much of a power supply for you. For those looking at 3-way CrossFire and GeForce GTX280 SLI look elsewhere too, as the M700 may not be



able to support adequate juice to the setup, and a power supply in the range of 1 Kilowatt may be required. If you're looking for something for a fast gaming rig that's not too heavy on power the M700 is worth a glance. At Rs 7,800, this PSU is overpriced, especially considering the excellent Corsair HX620, which offers nearly the same power output is priced at Rs 6,200 only.

Specifications
Total Power—700 Watts, four 12V rails, 1x 120mm fan,

modular, 8x SATA power connectors, 4x four pin connectors, 2x 6 pin PCIe connectors

Contact
Phone: 9833870302
E-mail: Tanmay_L@Coolermaster.com
Web site: www.coolermaster.com
Price: Rs 7,800

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★☆
Performance	★★★★☆
Build Quality	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆

BEC Technologies Billion BiGuard S6000 Secure Connections Galore

We're used to seeing network hubs and gateways, and then we saw the BiGuard S6000! Its very well built, has a great, industry grade silver finish, with the word *Billion* engraved on the top. What the BiGuard S6000 is, is a secure, VPN-based network hub that allows secure access of corporate resources from public terminals. In short the S6000 is a switch, with support for 2 parallel or separate WAN/Internet connections (RJ45). It is SSL secured—meaning secure links are possible from any remote terminal to access your enterprise resources with minimum risk. The S6000 has a couple of features worth mention. *Network Extender* allows for remote connections to internal network resources. *Transport*

Extender allows the use of the secure path created by the SSL secured route to be used for mail delivery. There is a fail over feature whereby, in case of network failure on one of the RJ45 ports, another takes over automatically, and both of these ports can also be set to balance loads between themselves. One of the best features for us was the fact that client-less connections are supported. This means that virtually anyone who has been authorised to access resources can do so. Another benefit is the support for multiple platforms, including flavours of Windows, Linux, and even PDA platforms. There is also a chat service which can be used for getting immediate technical support during



working hours. This service is offered for up to six months after registration. Firmware upgrades are also free, for a period of one year from the date of purchase. The BiGuard S6000 supports up to 200 secure *tunnels*, or information pathways at a time. The number of concurrent sessions is a whopping 1,20,000 or 50,000 (there are two versions), which should be enough for most medium-sized businesses. The inbuilt firewall has SPI (Stateful Packet Inspection), Packet Filter, Intrusion Detection, and Denial of Service prevention. A neat product and one that is sure to be appreciated

by business houses with employees always on the move. For anyone with an organisation consisting of less than 25 people - you can do without the S6000.

Specifications
2x RJ45 WAN/Internet ports, 8x RJ45 LAN ports, 2x USB, 1x RS232 control, VPN, SSL secured

Contact
Phone: 9821014253
E-mail: sales@onenetwork.co.in
Web site: www.onenetwork.co.in
Price: Rs 1,75,000 / 3,75,000

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★☆
Performance	★★★★☆
Build Quality	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆